CLASS X HISTORY — EXAM REVISION NOTES

All 11 chapters · timelines & diagrams · model answers · past-paper pointers

Built from the **BCSE 2025** and **2024** History question papers (Final I). Every question in both papers is solved inside.

How to use: Orange tags show where a topic appeared: P25 Q2a = 2025 paper question 2(a); P24 = 2024 paper. "Sec A" = the MCQ / fill-in / match / true-false part (Q1). Green boxes are **solved questions** with the mark value in brackets and the key answer in **red**. Purple tag diagram = a picture or diagram used in the paper. **Chapters:** 1 Indus Valley · 2 Vedic religion & Buddhism · 3 Age of Exploration · 4 Colonialism & Indian nationalism · 5 Historiography & culture · 6 Zhabdrung & the nation-state · 7 Bhutan & British India · 8 The monarchy & the Fourth Druk Gyalpo · 9 The Fifth Druk Gyalpo & the Royal Family · 10 Constitution, GNH & environment · 11 Civil society & community.

⚠ **Read this first — limits of these notes** I had the 2025 and 2024 papers only (no 2023 paper, no textbook), so a few answers rest on reasoning rather than the official key. They are marked **(check)**. (a) **2024 Q1a(vi)** triangular-trade options: none of A–D matches the standard triangle (X slaves, Y raw materials, Z manufactured goods); C is closest. (b) **2025 Q1a(xii)**: both A (I & III) and B (II & IV) pair one tangible with one intangible item. (c) **2025 Q1a(iii)** order of the Crown Prince's activities could not be checked; B is a best guess. (d) **2024 Q3a** (prophetic elements) is textbook-specific. (e) **2024 Q1a(v)**: B "Awakened One" vs D "Enlightened One" are both used. Always prefer the wording of **your own textbook** and your teacher's key.

How marks are given (both papers)

- **One point = one mark.** "Mention THREE points" [3], "FIVE points" [5] — write exactly that many, each on its own line, each a clear **fact + short explanation**. Extra points earn nothing.
- **"Do you agree / Do you think… Justify"**: begin with your stand (*Yes / No*), then give the reasons asked for. Opinion marks need reasons from the syllabus.
- **"As a… (Mughal Emperor, advisor, prayer captain, 16th Desi)…"**: answer **in role** using the history you have learned ("I would…").
- **"What would have happened if…"**: cause → effect points, written as consequences.
- **Case study / source:** use **names, dates and details from the passage** in every answer.
- Do **not** write your name, school or village (answer may be cancelled). Circle only ONE letter in MCQs.

Paper pattern (2024 & 2025)

Part	Content	Marks
Sec A Q1(a)	MCQ (15)	15
Q1(b)	Fill in blanks (7 in 2024; 5 in 2025)	7 / 5
Q1(c)	Match column I with II	5
Q1(d)	True / False (7 in 2024; 5 in 2025)	7 / 5
Q1(e)	Short answers (1–3 marks each; five parts in 2025)	6 / 10
Sec B Q2–Q7	Answer ALL: long answers of 2–5 marks (4–5 points)	60

Topic map: where each chapter appeared

Chapter	2024	2025
1 Indus Valley	Q1a(xiii), b(iii), e(i), Q2b	Q1e(v), Q6b
2 Vedic & Buddhism	Q1a(v,xv), Q4a, Q5a	Q1a(xiv), e(iv), Q7b,c
3 Exploration	Q1a(vi,vii), b(vii), d(iv)	Q1a(xv), c(i,v)
4 Colonialism	Q3c	Q7a
5 Historiography	Q1a(xi), b(ii), d(vii), Q4b	Q1a(xii,xiii), b(e), d(iv), Q6a
6 Zhabdrung	Q1a(iv,xiv), b(vi), e(iii), Q2a, Q6a, Q7a	Q1a(i,vii,viii), b(c,d), d(iii), Q2a
7 British India	Q1a(iii,x), c, d(iii), Q3b	Q1a(iv,x), b(a), Q2b–d, Q3b
8 Monarchy	Q1a(i), d(i), Q2c, Q3a, Q6b,c	Q1a(ii), e(i,iii), Q3a, Q4a
9 Fifth King & Family	Q1a(ii,ix,xii), b(vi), Q5b, Q7c	Q1a(iii,vi,ix), c, d(ii,v), e(ii), Q4b
10 Constitution & environment	Q1a(viii), d(v,vi), Q7b	Q1a(v), b(b), d(i), Q5a,b
11 Civil society & community	Q1a(ix), b(iv,v), e(ii)	Q1a(i), d(ii), Q5c

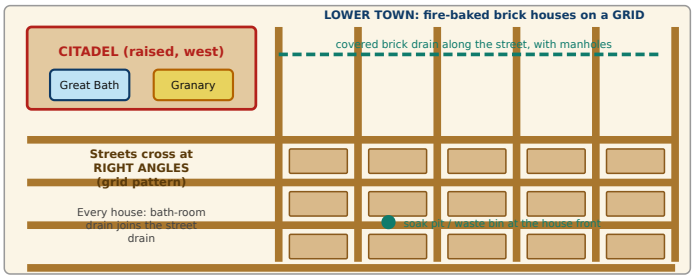
Repeated every year: Zhabdrung & Choe-sid / Kathrim • Bhutan–British treaties • the Fourth Druk Gyalpo (selfless leader, 2003) • His Majesty's programmes • Indus Valley drainage / town planning • Buddha's life • historiography • the Constitution & environment article.

1 · INDUS VALLEY CIVILISATION

P24 Q1a(xiii),b(iii),e(i),Q2b · P25 Q1e(v),Q6b

Key ideas

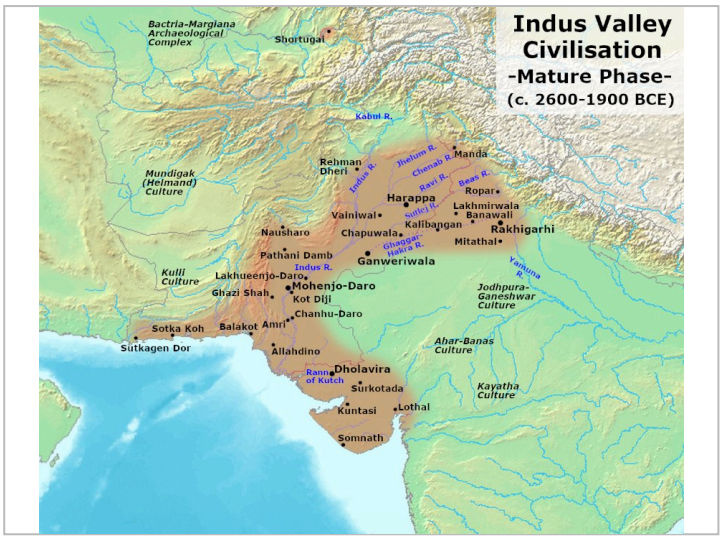
- **Time & place:** c. 3300–1300 BCE (mature phase c. 2600–1900 BCE) along the Indus and Ghaggar–Hakra rivers in present Pakistan and north-west India. Main sites: **Harappa** (found 1921), **Mohenjo-daro** (1922), Lothal (dockyard), Kalibangan, Dholavira. It was a **Bronze Age urban** civilisation.
- **Distinct features** P24 Q1a(xiii): B: planned towns (grid streets, citadel + lower town), **fire-baked (burnt) bricks**, an excellent **drainage system**, **pictographic seals** (steatite, undeciphered script), standard weights, fire-baked painted pottery, trade (Mesopotamia, Afghanistan), bullock-carts.
- **Town planning:** raised **citadel** in the west (Great Bath, granary) and a **lower town** with houses; streets cut each other at **right angles**; standard-size bricks (1:2:4); wells in houses and streets; public Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro. P25 Q6b
- **Drainage & sanitation:** every house had a bath-room and drain; house drains joined **covered brick drains** along the streets, with **manholes** and **soak pits**; **waste bins** stood outside shops/houses and were emptied. This kept the town clean and healthy — "effective **town planning / waste management**". P24 Q1b(iii) P25 Q1e(v)
- **Religion:** no big temples found. Evidence: terracotta **mother goddess** figures, the **"Pashupati" seal** (a seated, yoga-like figure surrounded by animals), worship of **trees (pipal), animals (bull) and water** (Great Bath for ritual bathing). So "worshipping in church" is wrong. P24 Q1e(i)



Plan of an Indus town: citadel (west) and a grid-pattern lower town with covered drains.



The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro, in the citadel of the Indus city.
Photo: Soban, CC BY-SA 3.0, Wikimedia Commons.



Map: Indus Valley Civilisation, mature phase (c. 2600–1900 BCE).
Photo: Avantiputra7, CC BY-SA 3.0, Wikimedia Commons.

Solved questions

P24 Q1e(i) [1] "The religious life of the Indus Valley shares similar features with Buddhist practices in Bhutan." Do you agree? **Yes.** The Indus people worshipped **nature — trees, animals and water** — and the "Pashupati" seal shows a **meditating (yogic) posture**; Bhutanese Buddhism also practises **meditation** and respect for sacred trees, rivers and animals. (One reason is enough.)

P24 Q2b [4] FOUR features of the Indus Valley Civilisation evident in my community:

1. **Planned town / roads:** Thimphu's organised streets and zones.
2. **Drainage & waste management:** covered drains, manholes and waste bins outside shops.
3. **Strong baked/durable buildings:** houses of bricks, cement and stone.
4. **Trade & markets:** weekend markets, weights and measures, barter/seal-like stamps on goods; also granaries/storage (community storehouses, dzong granaries).

P25 Q1e(v) [2] Effectiveness of the drainage system and TWO solutions: **Effective** because covered drains stopped flooding, sewage and disease, and house drains were linked to street drains with manholes for cleaning. **Solutions for my community:** (1) **build covered drains with manholes** and separate storm-water from waste-water; (2) **community waste bins + regular cleaning / rainwater harvesting and soak pits** so no waste enters the drains.

P25 Q6b [5] FIVE aspects of Indus town planning for modern cities:

1. **Grid-pattern roads** for easy movement.
2. **Covered drainage with manholes**.
3. **Zoning** — separate administrative/religious area and residential area.
4. **Standard durable bricks / strong buildings** and building rules.
5. **Public water supply, public baths, waste bins and community granaries** (planned services).

Sec A / blanks: P24 xiii **B** (fire-baked pottery, drainage pattern, pictographic seals). P24 b(iii) "…Indus Valley's effective **town planning / sanitation**".

Main sites

Site	Known for
Harappa (Punjab)	first site found (1921); granaries, workers' quarters; gave the civilisation its name
Mohenjo-daro (Sindh)	"mound of the dead"; **Great Bath**, large granary, best-planned streets
Lothal (Gujarat)	**dockyard**, bead-making, sea trade
Kalibangan (Rajasthan)	ploughed field, fire altars
Dholavira (Gujarat)	stepped water reservoirs — water conservation

Feature → why it mattered

Feature	Benefit
Grid streets	easy movement, orderly growth
Fire-baked bricks	strong, flood-resistant houses
Covered drains	clean streets, fewer diseases
Great Bath / wells	water supply, ritual bathing
Granary	food storage for the city
Seals and weights	trade, ownership, fair measures

2 · VEDIC RELIGION & BUDDHISM

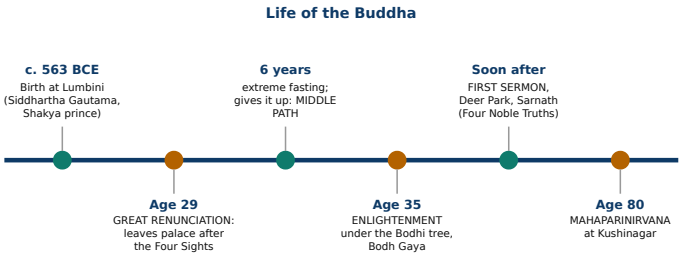
P24 Q1a(v,xv),Q4a,Q5a · P25 Q1a(xiv),Q1e(iv),Q7b,c

Vedic religion (c. 1500–600 BCE)

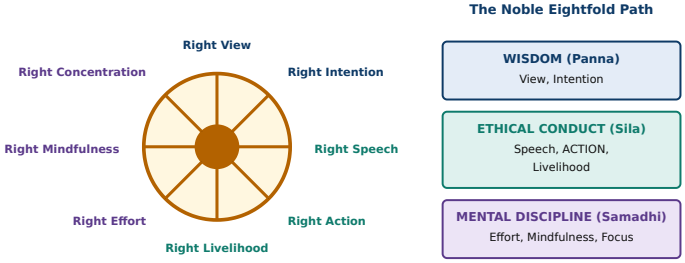
- Based on the **Vedas** (Rig Veda oldest). Gods of nature: Indra, Agni, Varuna, Surya. Worship by **yajna** (fire sacrifice) with chanting by **Brahmin priests**.
- **Animal sacrifice** (cows, horses — e.g. Ashvamedha) was part of the rituals; society divided into **four varnas** (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra) which became a rigid **caste system**.
- **Why Buddhism became prominent** P24 Q1a(xv): C: in the 6th century BCE India was in the **midst of religious and philosophical reform** — costly rituals, animal sacrifice, Brahmin dominance and caste discrimination made people look for simpler, more equal paths (Buddhism, Jainism, Upanishadic ideas). The new cities and traders supported them.

The Buddha

- **Siddhartha Gautama**, Shakya prince, born c. 563 BCE at **Lumbini** (Kapilavastu); father Suddhodana, mother Maya. Married Yashodhara; son Rahula. **Buddha = "Awakened One"** (from *budh*, to awaken) P24 Q1a(v): B **(check: D "Enlightened One" is also used)**.
- **Four Sights**: an old man, a sick man, a dead man, a wandering ascetic → **Great Renunciation** at 29: he left his palace to seek truth and an end to suffering. P25 Q1a(xiv): D
- Six years of **extreme fasting** nearly killed him → he accepted food (Sujata's rice-milk) and chose the **Middle Path** between luxury and self-torture. P25 Q1e(iv)
- **Enlightenment** at **Bodh Gaya** under the Bodhi tree (age 35) → **First Sermon** at Deer Park, **Sarnath** to five ascetics → taught for 45 years → **Mahaparinirvana** at Kushinagar (age 80).
- **Four Noble Truths:** (1) life has suffering (*dukkha*); (2) its cause is craving; (3) suffering can end (*nirvana*); (4) the way is the **Eightfold Path**.
- **Five precepts:** no killing, stealing, false speech, sexual misconduct or intoxicants. **Right Action** = not killing/harming, not stealing, no sexual misconduct.



Life of the Buddha — the key events and places.



The Noble Eightfold Path: wisdom, ethical conduct, mental discipline.



Standing Buddha, Gandhara art (1st–3rd century CE).
Photo: Ismoon, Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



Dhamek Stupa, Sarnath — where the Buddha gave his first sermon.
Photo: SpeakingArch, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

Solved questions

P25 Q1e(iv) [2] "Siddhartha denounced extreme asceticism in favour of the Middle Path." Justify with TWO reasons: (1) after **six years of severe fasting** his body became so weak he nearly died and he saw that **starving the body does not bring wisdom**; (2) he realised both **luxury (palace life) and self-torture are extremes** that fail to end suffering — so he accepted food, regained strength and **attained Enlightenment through balance and meditation**.

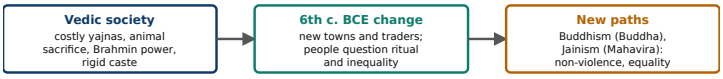
P25 Q7b [2] Illustrate TWO principles I practise daily: (1) **Kindness / compassion** — I share my lunch with a classmate who has none and look after stray dogs; (2) **Equality** — I treat all classmates, rich or poor, boys or girls, with the same respect and do not tease anyone. (Humanity: helping a sick neighbour or an old person.)

P25 Q7c [3] THREE ways to live in harmony through **Right Action**: (1) **do not harm or kill** any living being — solve disputes peacefully; (2) **do not steal or cheat** — respect others' property and be honest; (3) **act with care in relationships** and help others through community service (volunteering, sharing), avoiding sexual misconduct/intoxicants that hurt others.

P24 Q5a [5] "Animal sacrifice was essential in Vedic religion. Was it a good practice?" **No** — (1) it **causes cruelty and suffering** to innocent animals; (2) it **wasted valuable cattle** needed for farming and milk, harming the economy; (3) it **made rituals costly**, so poor people were excluded; (4) it **raised the priests' power** and caste inequality; (5) it was **against non-violence** and led to protest movements — **Buddhism and Jainism** taught *ahimsa*.

P24 Q4a [5] As prayer captain, FIVE activities to enhance spiritual life in my school: (1) lead **morning and evening prayers** and the Zhabdrung / Kuenrig prayer; (2) invite a **lama or teacher for a Dharma talk**; (3) organise **meditation sessions**; (4) arrange **butter-lamp and tshogs offerings** on auspicious days (e.g. Lhabab Duchen); (5) **clean the lhakhang** and plan **community-service / animal-release (tshethar)** activities. (Also: kora to a nearby temple, choeku, reading scriptures.)

Quick: P24 v B; xv C. P25 xiv **D** Great Renunciation (not First Sermon = Sarnath; Enlightenment = Bodh Gaya; Mahaparinirvana = death).



Why new religions arose in the 6th century BCE.

Vedic religion vs Buddhism

	Vedic	Buddhism
Worship	nature gods; fire sacrifice (yajna)	no creator god; meditation, ethics
Priests	Brahmins essential	monks (Sangha); no priest needed
Animals	sacrificed	non-violence (*ahimsa*)
Society	caste (varna) by birth	equality; all castes join the Sangha

Three Jewels & holy places

Holy places: Lumbini (birth), Bodh Gaya (Enlightenment), Sarnath (First Sermon), Kushinagar (Mahaparinirvana).

Three Jewels: the Buddha, the Dharma (teachings), the Sangha (community of monks).

Buddhism in Bhutan

- **7th century:** Tibetan king **Songtsen Gampo** built Kyichu (Paro) and Jampa (Bumthang) temples.
- **8th century (746): Guru Rinpoche** came to Bumthang (Sindhu Raja) and spread Vajrayana.
- **1616:** the Zhabdrung made **Drukpa Kagyu** the state religion.

Four Noble Truths

Truth	Meaning
1 Dukkha	life contains suffering (birth, age, illness, death)
2 Samudaya	suffering is caused by craving and attachment
3 Nirodha	suffering can end (nirvana)
4 Magga	the way is the Eightfold Path (the Middle Path)

The Eightfold Path in daily life

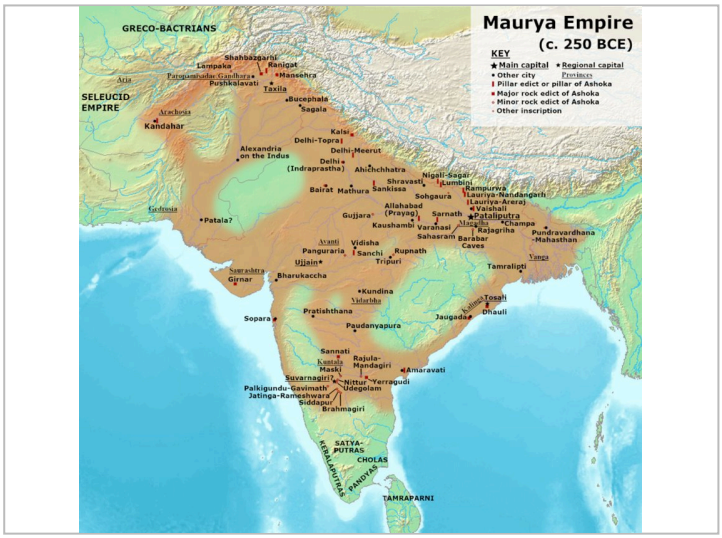
Path	In practice
Right View / Intention	understand the truths; kind, non-harmful thoughts
Right Speech	no lying, gossip or harsh words
Right Action	no killing, stealing or harming others
Right Livelihood	earn by honest work that harms nobody
Right Effort / Mindfulness / Concentration	self-discipline, awareness, meditation

Ashoka & the spread of Buddhism

- After the bloody **Kalinga war (261 BCE)** Emperor **Ashoka** turned to Buddhism and non-violence (*dhamma*), carved edicts on rocks and pillars and sent missionaries abroad (including to Sri Lanka).
- Buddhism travelled along trade routes to Central Asia, China, Tibet and South-East Asia; later the **Vajrayana** form reached Bhutan.



An Ashoka pillar at Lauriya Nandangarh (Bihar), carrying his edicts on dhamma.
Photo: Sir Benjamin Simpson, Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



Map: the Maurya Empire under Ashoka, c. 250 BCE.
Photo: Avantiputra7, CC BY-SA 3.0, Wikimedia Commons.

Likely questions

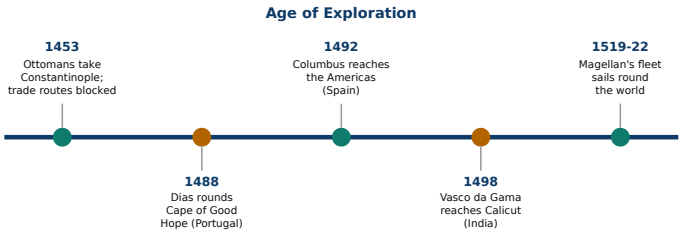
- **Describe the Buddha's life in five points:** birth at Lumbini → Four Sights and Great Renunciation (29) → six years of austerity and the Middle Path → Enlightenment at Bodh Gaya (35) → First Sermon at Sarnath and 45 years of teaching until Mahaparinirvana at Kushinagar (80).
- **Why did people accept Buddhism?** simple teachings in local language, no costly rituals, equality for all castes, non-violence.

3 · THE AGE OF EXPLORATION

P24 Q1a(vi,vii),b(vii),d(iv) · P25 Q1a(xv),c(i,v)

Key ideas

- **When & who:** 15th–17th centuries; pioneers were **Portugal and Spain** (later Holland, England, France).
- **Causes (the 3 Gs): God** (spread Christianity), **Gold** (wealth, spices, trade) and **Glory** (power and fame). The Ottoman capture of Constantinople (**1453**) blocked the old land routes, so Europe searched for **sea routes** to Asia. P24 Q1b(vii) ("…as well as for spreading **Christianity**").
- **Equipment used by explorers: map, ship (caravel), compass, astrolabe**. The **printing press** was NOT sailors' equipment. P24 Q1a(vii): D
- **Voyages: Dias** rounded the Cape of Good Hope (1488); **Columbus** (Spain) reached the Americas in 1492; **Vasco da Gama** reached Calicut, India, by sea in 1498; **Magellan's** fleet sailed round the world (1519–22).
- **Effects — positive: globalisation: economic and cultural links** P25 Q1a(xv): D; the **Columbian Exchange** spread crops (potato, maize, tomato), animals, ideas, technology and goods P25 Q1c(v): d. Columbus; better maps and knowledge. **Negative:** conquest and colonisation, **slave trade**, diseases (smallpox) that killed millions of native people, loss of native cultures.
- **Triangular trade:** Europe → West Africa carrying **manufactured goods** (guns, cloth, iron); Africa → the Americas carrying **enslaved Africans** (Middle Passage); Americas → Europe carrying **raw materials** (sugar, cotton, tobacco). P24 Q1a(vi) triangular trade map
- **Maritime trade conflict:** reasons include trade-route control and a **growing demand for marine resources** (fish, oil, minerals) → **TRUE** P24 Q1d(iv).



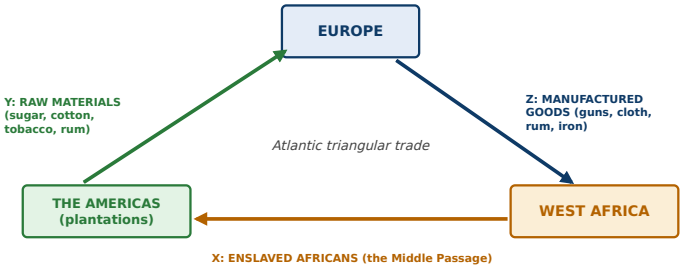
Age of Exploration: key dates.



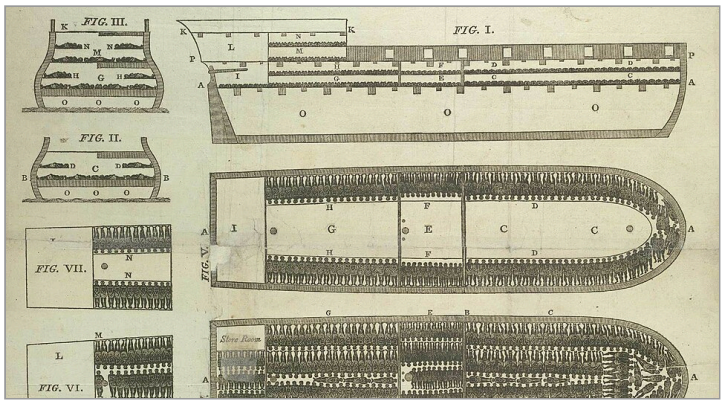
Replica of the *Santa María*, Columbus's flagship (1492).
Photo: Unknown author, Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



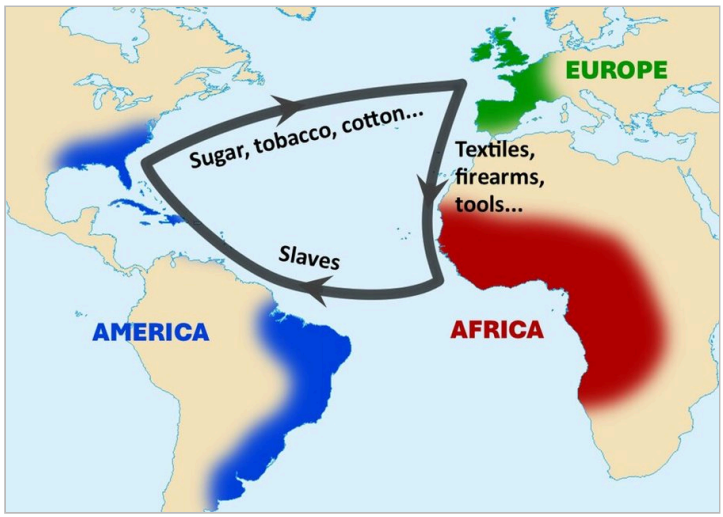
Map: Portuguese and Spanish routes of the Age of Exploration.
Photo: World_Topography.jpg: NASA/JPL/NIMA deri..., Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



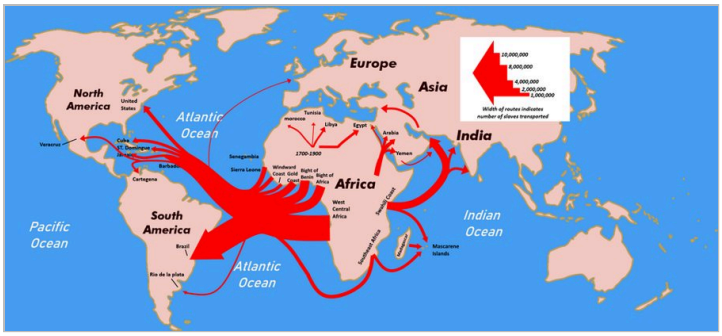
The Atlantic triangular trade (correct pairing: X slaves, Y raw materials, Z manufactured goods).



Plan of the slave ship *Brookes* (1788): enslaved Africans packed below deck.
Photo: Printed by James Phillips, George Yard,..., Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



Map: the Atlantic triangular trade.
Photo: Jefunky, CC0, Wikimedia Commons.



Map: the Atlantic slave trade — arrows show the number of people carried.
Photo: KuroNekoNiyah, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

(check) P24 Q1a(vi): the options in the paper do not contain the standard pairing. In the map the arrow Africa→Americas (X) = **slaves**; this matches only option **C** (X slaves), so C is the closest. Confirm with your teacher's key.

Quick answers: P25 c(i) mechanism to involve people… = see Ch 8; c(v) "global trade spread ideas, crops, animals, diseases" → **d (Christopher Columbus)**; a (Vasco da Gama) = sea route to India. P24 vii **D**.

Who did what

Explorer	Country	Achievement
Prince Henry the Navigator	Portugal	sponsored voyages and navigation school
Bartolomeu Dias	Portugal	rounded the Cape of Good Hope, 1488
Christopher Columbus	Spain	reached the Americas, 1492
Vasco da Gama	Portugal	sea route to India (Calicut), 1498
Pedro Cabral	Portugal	reached Brazil, 1500
Ferdinand Magellan	Spain	expedition that first circled the globe, 1519–22
Cortes / Pizarro	Spain	conquered the Aztec (1521) / Inca (1530s) empires

Effects: positive and negative

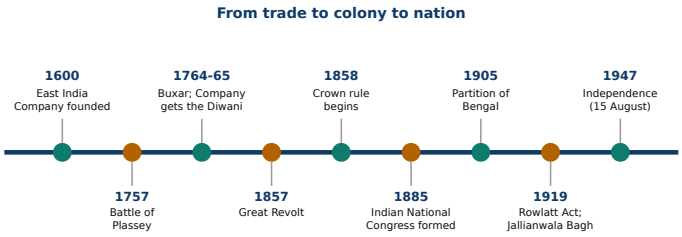
Positive	Negative
global trade and cultural links (globalisation)	conquest and colonisation
exchange of crops (potato, maize, tomato) and animals	slave trade of Africans
better maps and scientific knowledge	diseases such as smallpox killed natives
new foods, goods and ideas spread	loss of native cultures and land

4 · COLONIALISM & INDIAN NATIONALISM

P24 Q3c · P25 Q7a

Key ideas

- **British rise:** East India Company (1600) → factories (Surat 1612, Madras, Bombay, Calcutta) → **Plassey 1757** and **Buxar 1764** → the **Diwani** (right to collect revenue of Bengal, 1765) → subsidiary alliances and the Doctrine of Lapse → **Revolt of 1857** → **Crown rule 1858**.
- **Why the Mughals weakened:** Aurangzeb's death (1707), wars of succession, weak emperors, revolts of Marathas, Rajputs, Nawabs; Nadir Shah's invasion (1739). The emperor's 1717 **farman** gave the Company **duty-free trade** in Bengal.
- **Colonial rule:** heavy land tax, ruin of handicrafts (de-industrialisation), famines, racial discrimination, Indians kept out of high posts.
- **Rise of nationalism:** English education and Western ideas (liberty, equality); newspapers; reformers (Ram Mohan Roy, Arya Samaj); railways and telegraph linking the country; unpopular acts (**Partition of Bengal 1905, Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh 1919**). **Indian National Congress** founded **1885**; Gandhi's non-violent movements; **independence 15 Aug 1947**.



Indian history under the British: key dates.

Solved questions

P24 Q3c [4] "Colonialism was the main reason behind the rise of Indian nationalism." Do you agree? **Yes, largely.** (1) **Economic exploitation** — high taxes, destruction of handicrafts and famines united people against the British. (2) **Political domination and racial discrimination** — Indians were denied high posts and rights, so they demanded self-rule. (3) **Western education and the press** (a colonial creation) taught ideas of freedom and let leaders connect; the **Congress** was formed in 1885. (4) **Oppressive laws** (Partition of Bengal, Rowlatt Act, Jallianwala Bagh) turned moderate opinion into mass movements. (Other causes, e.g. social reform, helped but the British rule created the common enemy.)

P25 Q7a [5] As a Mughal Emperor, FIVE measures to stop British colonisation: (1) **cancel the duty-free trading farman** and tax British goods like other traders; (2) **allow no forts or private armies** in Company factories and keep ports under Mughal officers; (3) **unite the Rajputs, Marathas and Nawabs** and end succession wars so the empire speaks with one voice; (4) **modernise the army** with muskets, artillery and a navy, and pay soldiers regularly; (5) **play European powers (French, Dutch, Portuguese) against the British** and gather intelligence on their plans.

Cause and effect

Event	Effect
Plassey 1757	Company controls Bengal politics
Diwani 1765	right to collect revenue; drain of wealth
Subsidiary Alliance (Wellesley)	princes lose independence
Doctrine of Lapse (Dalhousie)	states annexed; discontent
Revolt of 1857	Crown rule from 1858
Partition of Bengal 1905	Swadeshi movement
Jallianwala Bagh 1919	mass anger; non-cooperation (1920–22)
Salt March 1930; Quit India 1942	mass civil disobedience → freedom 1947

5 · HISTORIOGRAPHY, ORAL HISTORY & CULTURE

P24 Q1a(xi),b(ii),d(vii),Q4b · P25 Q1a(xii,xiii),b(e),d(iv),Q6a

Key ideas

- **History** = study of the past. **Historiography** = the study of *how* history is written (the methods, sources and viewpoints of historians).
- **Medieval historiography:** written by **monks, priests and court scribes** for religion or rulers; history shown as the **will and deeds of God** and of **kings**; mixed with **myths, miracles and legends**; focus on wars, dynasties, saints; ordinary people ignored. So it is best described as a **historical account influenced by religious beliefs** P24 Q1a(xi): B. In 2025 blank (e): "…recounting the will of deeds of God and **kings / rulers**".
- **Modern historiography:** based on **reason, evidence and critical study** of sources; **objective**; many themes (society, economy, women, environment, common people); uses archaeology, science, **oral history**; includes different **schools**: **romanticist** (emotion and imagination, glorifying heroes and the nation) and **rationalist** (reason and evidence) P24 Q1b(ii): reason / evidence P25 Q1d(iv): TRUE.
- **Oral history** = first-hand memories of living people about events they saw, collected by **interviews** (recent past). **Oral tradition** = stories, songs, proverbs and customs **handed down by word of mouth over generations**. They are related but **not interchangeable** → **FALSE** P24 Q1d(vii).
- **Humanising history:** personal narratives let readers "connect emotionally with the experiences of individuals" and build **empathy** P25 Q1a(xiii): A. Others: *inclusivity and diverse voices*, *cultural heritage*, *community building*.
- **Culture: tangible** = things you can touch (dzongs, Taktsang, thangkas, textiles, kera shoes); **intangible** = living practices (mask dances, folk songs, rituals, language, oral literature). P25 Q1a(xii) 4 photos **(check)** I mask dance = intangible; II Taktsang = tangible; III traditional shoes = tangible; IV song/dance group = intangible → both A (I & III) and B (II & IV) pair one of each; B is slightly cleaner (an *architectural monument* + a *performing tradition*).
- Bhutan must **prioritise the promotion and preservation of culture / cultural heritage and traditions** in a globalising world P24 Q1b(iv).

MEDIEVAL historiography		MODERN historiography
Based on religion, will of God, myths	vs	Based on reason and evidence
Focus: kings, wars, saints, glory of rulers	vs	Focus: all people, society, economy, women, environment
Written by monks / court scribes (patrons)	vs	Written by trained historians (objective)
Sources taken on trust, no checking	vs	Sources cross-checked; archaeology, oral history
Single (religious / royal) viewpoint	vs	Many viewpoints; inclusive voices

Medieval vs modern historiography at a glance.



Cham mask dance at a tshechu — **intangible** cultural heritage.
Photo: Arian Zwegers from Brussels, Belgium, CC BY 2.0, Wikimedia Commons.



Paro Taktsang (Tiger's Nest) — **tangible** cultural heritage.
Photo: Bernard Gagnon, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

Solved questions

P24 Q4b [5] FIVE focuses of historical writing in the **medieval** period: (1) **religion and the will of God** — events explained as divine plan; (2) **kings and rulers**, their glory and victories; (3) **wars, conquests and dynasties**; (4) **lives of saints and holy men** (e.g. Bhutan's *namthars*); (5) **myths, miracles and legends** written by monks and court scribes to please patrons; common people were ignored.

P25 Q6a [5] Why historians prefer **modern** over medieval historiography: (1) it is **rational and evidence-based**, not myth; (2) it is **objective**, checking facts from many sources; (3) it covers **all people** — women, workers, minorities — not only kings; (4) it uses **science and oral history** (archaeology, carbon dating, interviews); (5) it studies **cause and effect** and offers many viewpoints, so we learn lessons accurately.

Quick: P24 xi **B**; b(ii) rationalist = **reason / evidence**; d(vii) **FALSE**. P25 xiii **A**; d(iv) **TRUE**.

Oral history vs oral tradition

	Oral history	Oral tradition
Meaning	memories of events a person lived	stories, songs, customs passed through generations
Time	recent past	long past
Collected by	interviews and recordings	listening, repetition, performance
Example	an elder describing a flood	folk tale of a place, ballads, proverbs

Sources of history

- **Primary:** treaties, diaries (Turner), letters, inscriptions, photos. **Secondary:** textbooks, later studies.
- **Types:** written, archaeological, oral, visual.

Why study history?

- learn from the past; build identity; understand cause and effect; respect other cultures.

6 · ZHABDRUNG & THE NATION-STATE

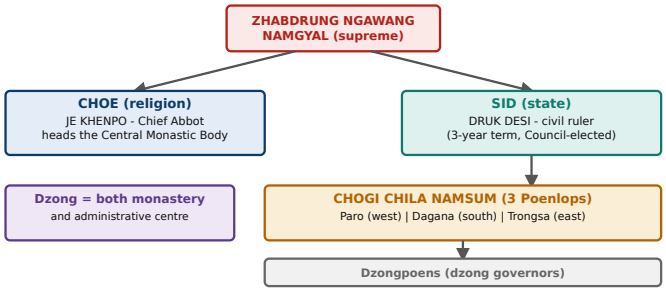
P24 Q1a(iv,xiv),e(iii),Q2a,Q6a,Q7a · P25 Q1a(vii,viii),b(c,d),c(ii),d(iii),Q2a

Zhabdrung Ngawang Namgyal (1594–1651)

- Born at **Ralung, Tibet**, head of the **Drukpa Kagyu**; left Tibet after a dispute with the Tsang ruler and arrived in Bhutan in **1616**. He built the first dzong (**Simtokha, 1629**), then Punakha (1637), Wangdue and Paro, and drove back the **Tibetan–Mongol invasions** (1634, 1639, 1644). Called **Palden Drukpa** and the **Architect of the Nation State** because he **created a unique national identity** P24 Q1a(xiv): B. His death in 1651 was kept secret for decades; his preserved body (**Machhen**) rests at Punakha Dzong.
- **Laid the foundation of Bhutan's emergence as a nation-state** despite internal strife P25 Q1c(ii): g. Zhabdrung.

The Choe-sid (Ten-Sid) dual system

- **Choe** = religion; **Sid** = state. The **Je Khenpo** heads the monastic body; the **Druk Desi** runs the civil administration. "**Ten-Sid**" = the **duality of spiritual and secular affairs** P25 Q1a(viii): A.
- **Chogi Chila Namsum** = the **three Poenlops: Trongsa, Dagana and Paro** P24 Q1a(iv): C (not Desi/Je Khenpo, Drongyer etc.). Below them the **Dzongpoens**.
- **Significance** P24 Q2a: balanced spiritual and secular power; kept **peace and stability** (until 1907); unified valleys under dzong administration; preserved Drukpa Kagyu identity; checks and balances.



The Choe-sid system set up by the Zhabdrung.



Portrait of Zhabdrung Ngawang Namgyal, unifier of Bhutan.
Photo: Unknown, CC0, Wikimedia Commons.

Laws, etiquette & identity

- **Kathrim** (Zhabdrung's law code): fundamentals **Lay-Gyudrey** (law of cause and effect/karma), **Tha-Damtsig** (sacred bond of loyalty) and the **ten virtuous acts**. They still **resonate in modern Bhutanese society** P25 Q1b(d). Kathrim was the supreme law of the **17th century**, not of modern times (the Constitution is) → **FALSE** P25 Q1d(iii).
- **Two laws of the 17th century:** the **spiritual law of the silken knot** and the **secular law of the golden yoke** P25 Q1a(vii): B. Later the **Thrimzhung Chenmo** (1729) codified law.
- **Driglam Namzha** = Bhutanese code of etiquette (dress, conduct, respect) promoted by the Zhabdrung P25 Q1b(c).

Solved questions

P24 Q2a [2] TWO significances of the Choe-sid: (1) it **balanced religious and secular authority**, preventing misuse of power; (2) it brought **unity, peace and stable government** to the country for 250 years.

P24 Q1e(iii) [3] What if the Zhabdrung had not codified the Kathrim? (1) **No common law** — disputes, crime and lawlessness; (2) **no unity** among valleys, making Bhutan **weak against Tibetan invasion**; (3) **no moral/ethical code** (karma, loyalty) and no foundation for later laws (Thrimzhung Chenmo, Constitution) or **national identity**.

P24 Q6a [3] THREE importance of Kathrim: (1) **foundation of the Bhutanese legal system**; (2) **maintained peace, order and justice** through moral principles; (3) **unified people** and strengthened national identity; it still guides values today.

P24 Q7a [2] TWO factors that led the Zhabdrung to create a unique identity: (1) the need to **unite warring valleys** and resist **Tibetan invasions**; (2) a wish to establish a **distinct Drukpa Kagyu Buddhist state**, separate from Tibet, with its own dress, etiquette, language, dzong architecture and festivals.

P25 Q2a [5] How the Zhabdrung promoted **social cohesion** through a strong national identity: (1) **one religion** — Drukpa Kagyu — for all; (2) **Kathrim**, a common law; (3) **Driglam Namzha**: shared dress, etiquette and conduct; (4) **dzongs** as common centres of administration, rituals and festivals (tshechus); (5) **Choe-sid** government and **victory over Tibetan invasions** made people feel one nation.

Zhabdrung's achievements

Area	What he did
Political	unified valleys; Choe-sid government; 3 regions under Poenlops
Military	repelled Tibetan–Mongol invasions (1634, 1639, 1644)
Religious	Drukpa Kagyu as state religion; monastic body under the Je Khenpo
Legal	Kathrim; spiritual and secular law
Cultural	Driglam Namzha, dzong architecture, festivals, Dzongkha



Punakha Dzong (1637), founded by the Zhabdrung at the meeting of the Pho Chhu and Mo Chhu.

Photo: Bernard Gagnon, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

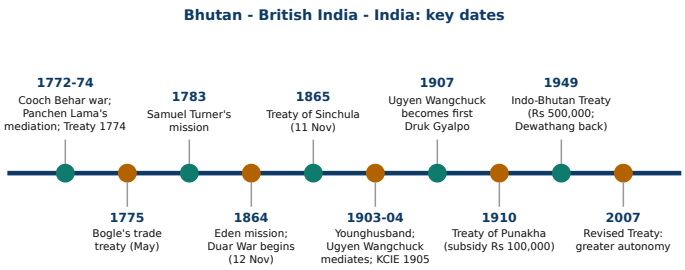
Dzongs: why they matter

Dzong	Founded
Simtokha	1629 (first dzong)
Punakha	1637
Wangdue Phodrang	1638

A dzong is a **fortress, monastery and administrative centre** in one: it defended the valley, held monks and officials, and hosted tshechus — the visible sign of **Choe-sid**.

7 · BHUTAN & BRITISH INDIA: TREATIES

P24 Q1a(iii,x),c,d(iii),Q3b · P25 Q1a(iv,x),b(a),Q2(case study b–d),Q3b



Bhutan–British India–India: key dates.

Timeline & treaties

Year	Event / terms
1772–74	**Cooch Behar war** under Desi **Zhidar** (16th Desi); the Raja asked the British for help; Bhutan lost. **Desi Kunga Rinchen** (17th, succeeded Zhidar) asked the **Panchen Lama** to mediate → **Treaty of 25 April 1774** with **Warren Hastings**: first treaty, peace.
1775 (May)	**George Bogle's treaty**: Bhutanese traders free of duty at **Rangpur**, caravans allowed to trade across Bengal, trading rights for goods such as sandalwood and betel-nut. The **British opening a trade agent in Bhutan** was **not** a gain for Bhutan P25 Q1a(x): B.
1783	**Samuel Turner** mission; met **Desi Jigme Sengye**; his diaries gave Britain political information P24 Q1c(iii).
1864	**Ashley Eden mission** to Punakha was humiliated and forced to sign; Britain annexed **Ambari Falakata** and declared war on **12 Nov 1864** (**Duar War**). Had Eden succeeded: **no war**, so the **Assam and Bengal Duars would not have been annexed** P24 Q1a(iii): C.
11 Nov 1865	**Treaty of Sinchula**: Bhutan ceded the **Assam Duars, Bengal Duars and Dewangiri** (about a fifth of its land) for an annual payment (Rs 25,000, rising to **Rs 50,000**); **peace and friendship** established P25 Q1a(iv): D. Led by **Trongsa Poenlop Jigme Namgyel** P24 Q1c(iv): a.
1903–04	**Younghusband expedition** to Tibet (British fear of Russia). **Ugyen Wangchuck** mediated successfully → Anglo-Tibetan Treaty **7 Sept 1904**; **KCIE 1905**.
1907	Ugyen Wangchuck crowned first **Druk Gyalpo** (17 Dec).
1910	**Treaty of Punakha**: subsidy raised to **Rs 100,000**; Bhutan "guided" by Britain in external affairs; Britain not to interfere internally. (Not the first treaty → 2024 d(iii) **FALSE**.)
1949	**Treaty of Friendship with independent India**: **Rs 500,000** compensation, **32 sq. miles at Dewathang** returned, non-interference.
2007	**Revised treaty**: Bhutan no longer has to be guided by India in external relations → **greater autonomy in managing its foreign affairs** P24 Q1a(x): D.

Matching P24 Q1c

Column I	Ans
i. Fought personally against British-India but later exiled	**b** Desi Zhidar **(check)**
ii. Asked the Panchen Lama to mediate; Anglo-Bhutanese treaty	**d** Desi Kunga Rinchen
iii. Received Turner's mission, diaries	**f** Desi Jigme Sengye
iv. Led the Duar War, Sinchula	**a** Trongsa Poenlop Jigme Namgyel
v. Mediated between Tibet and British India	**c** Ugyen Wangchuck

Solved questions

P25 Q1b(a) [1] ...Ugyen Wangchuck communicated with the Tibetan authorities to negotiate with the **British** (Younghusband).

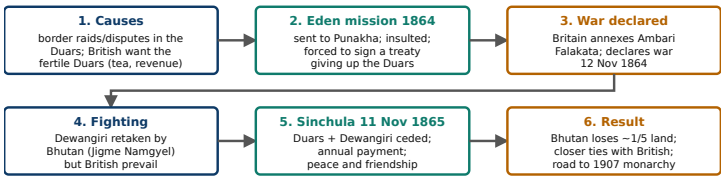
P25 Q2(b) [1] How Ugyen Wangchuck's leadership inspires me to resolve disputes: by **staying calm, listening to both sides and using patient dialogue** (not force) — as he met Colonel Younghusband in person at Chumbi.

P25 Q2(c) [2] Applying his diplomacy today: (1) **neutral mediation and dialogue** to settle conflicts peacefully (e.g. UN talks); (2) **building trust** with both sides and keeping communication open, then moving step by step to a written agreement.

P25 Q2(d) [2] Long-term effects: (1) **strong, trusting ties with British India**, raising Bhutan's standing and protecting its **independence**; (2) it **strengthened the Wangchuck family**, leading to the **monarchy in 1907** and treaties in 1910 that continued friendship.

P25 Q3(b) [5] As an advisor, improve relations using the **2007 treaty autonomy**: (1) **open more embassies** and strengthen diplomacy; (2) **join international organisations** (UN, BIMSTEC, SAARC); (3) **widen trade and hydropower/tourism markets** beyond one country; (4) **cultural and GNH diplomacy** — exchange programmes, scholarships; (5) keep **close friendship with India** while cooperating on climate and regional security.

P24 Q3b [3] As the **16th Desi Zhidar** betrayed by allies in the conflict (Cooch Behar): (1) **seek peace through a respected mediator** (the Panchen Lama) and negotiate a treaty; (2) **rebuild unity at home** — reconcile officials, test the loyalty of allies and reward the faithful; (3) **strengthen defence and avoid over-extension** — guard the passes and keep trade open so the British have fewer reasons to fight.



The Duar War: cause-and-effect chain.

Likely questions

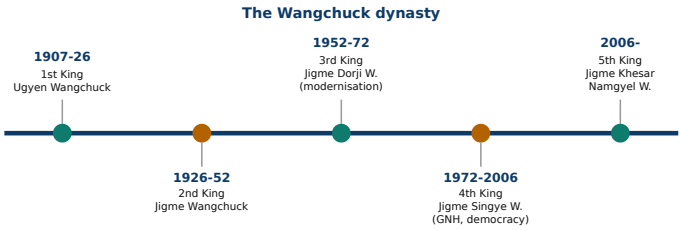
- **Causes of the Duar War:** border disputes and raids in the Duars; British wish for the fertile Duars (revenue, tea, route to Tibet); the failed Eden mission.
- **Effects of Sinchula:** Bhutan lost the Duars and Dewangiri (about a fifth of its land) but gained a yearly payment and peace.
- **Why did the British support Ugyen Wangchuck?** He proved a skilled mediator in 1904; he later became the stable ruler of a united Bhutan (1907).

8 · THE MONARCHY & THE FOURTH DRUK GYALPO

P24 Q1a(i),d(i),Q3a,Q6c · P25 Q1a(ii),c(i),e(iii),Q3a,Q4a

The Wangchuck dynasty

- **Jigme Namgyel** (Trongsa Poenlop, 1825–81) strengthened Trongsa's power. His son **Ugyen Wangchuck** united the country, mediated for Britain (1904) and was **elected first Druk Gyalpo on 17 Dec 1907** (National Day).
- **2nd King Jigme Wangchuck** (1926–52). **3rd King Jigme Dorji Wangchuck** (1952–72), "Father of modern Bhutan": National Assembly (1953), end of serfdom, Five Year Plans from 1961, High Court, UN membership 1971.
- The **Third Five Year Plan** (1971–76: communications, irrigation, health, education, agriculture) was chaired by **Prince Jigme Singye Wangchuck** P25 Q1a(ii): B.



The five Kings of Bhutan.



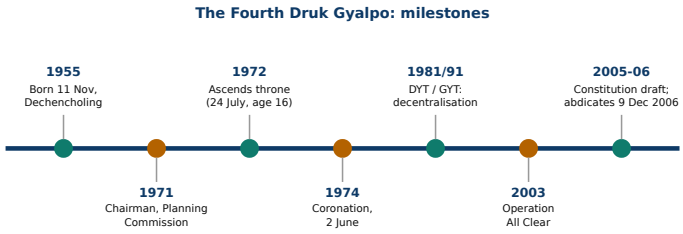
Sir Ugyen Wangchuck with his councillors at Punakha, 1905 — the first Druk Gyalpo.
Photo: John Claude White, Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.



Trongsa Dzong — seat of the Trongsa Poenlops, from where the Wangchuck family rose.
Photo: Christopher J. Fynn, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

The Fourth Druk Gyalpo

- Born **11 Nov 1955** at Dechencholing, Thimphu. He ascended the throne on **24 July 1972** aged 16; he was formally **enthroned/crowned on 2 June 1974** P24 Q1a(i): A. On **16 June 1972** he was appointed **Trongsa Poenlop** and received the red scarf (Kabney) → **TRUE** P24 Q1d(i) **(check)**.
- **Gross National Happiness (GNH)** — wellbeing above GDP. **Decentralisation: Dzongkhag Yargay Tshogdu** (1981) and **Gewog Yargay Tshogchung** (1991) — the **mechanism to involve people in grassroots decision-making** P25 Q1c(i): c. Fourth DG.
- **Conservation:** 60% forest cover, protected areas. **Modernisation:** hydropower, free education and health.
- **Operation All Clear (Dec 2003):** after years of talks, His Majesty **personally led the army** to remove militant camps (ULFA, NDFB, KLO) from southern Bhutan — with minimal damage. P25 Q1e(iii) P24 Q6c
- **Democracy:** started drafting the **Constitution (2001)**; **abdicated on 9 Dec 2006** in favour of the Crown Prince — before the people demanded change.



Milestones of the Fourth Druk Gyalpo's reign.



The Fourth Druk Gyalpo, Jigme Singye Wangchuck.
Photo: U.S. Department of State, Public domain, Wikimedia Commons.

Solved questions

P25 Q3a [5] Why the Fourth Druk Gyalpo is a **"Selfless Leader"**: (1) in **2003** he **led the troops personally from the front**, risking his life for the nation; (2) he **voluntarily abdicated in 2006** and gave up power; (3) he **gave democracy and the Constitution** as a gift, not under pressure; (4) he made **GNH** the aim — wellbeing of people over personal wealth; (5) he **decentralised power** to the people and travelled to remote villages, serving rather than ruling.

P25 Q4a [5] Speech: FIVE key aspects of his leadership/legacy: (1) **GNH philosophy**; (2) **decentralisation and democracy** (DYT/GYT, Constitution); (3) **environmental conservation** — 60% forest cover for all time; (4) **national security** — Operation All Clear 2003; (5) **socio-economic development & culture** — hydropower, schools, hospitals and preservation of tradition — capped by his **selfless abdication**.

P24 Q6c [4] Inspiration from his selfless leadership in 2003: (1) **put the nation before self** — I should serve my school/community before my comfort; (2) **lead by example and be present** in difficult times; (3) **prepare carefully and choose peace first** (talks before force) — solve conflicts patiently; (4) **be ready to sacrifice** time and personal gain for others' safety and happiness.

P25 Q1e(iii) [2] TWO lessons from the 2003 military operation: (1) **dialogue and patience first, force as last resort** — militants were given time to leave peacefully; (2) **strong leadership with careful planning and unity** — the King led from the front, trained the forces and united the people, so the mission succeeded with few casualties.

P24 Q3a [3] **(check — textbook-specific)** Prophetic elements around the birth of the Fourth Druk Gyalpo: (1) he was born into the **Wangchuck line foretold by the prophecies of Guru Rinpoche/Pema Lingpa** to protect Bhutan's Dharma; (2) **auspicious signs and dates** accompanied the birth at Dechencholing (11 Nov 1955); (3) **lamas confirmed** that he would become a great protector and leader. Use the exact signs listed in your textbook.

The Third King: modernisation

Year	Step
1953	National Assembly (Tshogdu) set up
1956	land reform; serfdom abolished
1961	First Five Year Plan; Thimphu capital
1968	High Court and Council of Ministers
1971	Bhutan joins the United Nations

Fourth King: reign in brief

- **1972:** ascends the throne at 16. **1974:** coronation.
- **1981 / 1991:** Dzongkhag and Gewog development committees (DYT, GYT).
- **1998:** hands over executive power to the Council of Ministers.
- **2001–05:** Constitution drafted. **2003:** Operation All Clear. **2006:** abdication.

9 · THE FIFTH DRUK GYALPO & THE ROYAL FAMILY

P24 Q1a(ii,ix,xii),b(v,vi),Q2c,Q5b,Q6b,Q7c · P25 Q1a(iii,vi,ix),c(iii,iv),d(ii,v),e(i,ii),Q4b

His Majesty Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck



His Majesty Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck, the Fifth Druk Gyalpo.
Photo: Royal Family of Bhutan, CC BY-SA 3.0, Wikimedia Commons.

- Born **21 Feb 1980**. **Education:** Bhutan, then **Phillips Academy (Andover)**, **Wheaton College** (USA) and **Magdalen College, Oxford** (foreign service programme) — gave global exposure, languages and understanding of world affairs. P25 Q1e(i)
- Installed as the **16th Trongsa Poenlop on 31 Oct 2004**; **Fifth Druk Gyalpo on 9 Dec 2006**; coronation 2008. At **Punakha** he received the **Dar Kha Nga from Machhen** — the **blessings of the Zhabdrung** P25 Q1a(vi): B; the ceremonies at Punakha (protector of **Chhoe**) and at Tashichhodzong (protector of **Sid**) → **TRUE** P24 Q1d(ii).
- **Royal wedding: 13 Oct 2011 at Punakha Dzong → TRUE** P25 Q1d(v). Gyalsey Jigme Namgyel Wangchuck born in the Fire-Monkey year 2016; the Druk Gyalpo (Iron Monkey, 1980) and Gyalsey were both born in a Monkey year that is also a **leap year** P24 Q1b(vi).
- **As Crown Prince:** opened the Zilukha school fete, addressed the Japan Day celebrations, presided over the passing-out of Royal Bodyguards and opened the first juvenile rehabilitation complex at Tsimalakha. Correct order: **B (I, III, II, IV)** P25 Q1a(iii) **(check)**.
- **Ceremony: Zhugdrel Phuensum Tshogpa** (prelude at all levels of celebration) symbolises the **unity and nationhood of Bhutan** P25 Q1a(i): A.

His Majesty's programmes

Initiative	What it does
Kidu	Royal welfare: land, housing, scholarships, medical help, disaster relief; reaches remote people. P24 Q7c
Desuung (2011)	"Guardians of Peace": volunteer training in service, discipline, skills.
Gyalsung	Announced 17 Dec 2019; **one-year compulsory training for 18-year-olds**; first batch 2024. P25 Q1c(iii): e. Druk Gyalpo (P25 Q1d(ii) TRUE)
Royal Highland Festival (Laya, 2016)	Preserves highland culture and improves highlanders' **socio-economic conditions / livelihoods → economic initiative, B** P24 Q1a(ii) **(check)**.
Gelephu Mindfulness City	Announced Dec 2023: a GNH-based economic zone.

The Queen Mothers & Her Majesty the Gyaltsuen

Royal	Known for
Her Majesty **The Gyaltsuen Jetsun Pema**	Patron of the **Bhutan Red Cross Society**: **alleviate human suffering during emergencies and disasters** P25 Q1a(ix): C.
Gyalyum **Sangay Choden**	**Women empowerment** — RENEW, Royal Textile Academy.
Gyalyum **Dorji Wangmo**	**Poverty alleviation** — Tarayana Foundation P24 Q1a(xii): C **(check)**.
Gyalyum **Tseyring Pem**	**Youth**: Golden Youth Award (with the Bhutan Youth Development Fund) → youth values, culture, sports P25 Q1c(iv): b **(check)**.

Solved questions

P25 Q1e(i) [2] How his education prepared him: (1) **studied in the USA and UK** (Andover, Wheaton, Oxford), gaining **global exposure and knowledge of world affairs/diplomacy**; (2) he combined this with **Bhutanese schooling and values**, so he can **lead the country while understanding modern challenges**.

P25 Q1e(ii) [2] His Majesty's disaster relief builds trust: (1) after the **2009 eastern earthquake and the 2012 Wangdue Phodrang Dzong fire** His Majesty visited victims and granted **Kidu** for housing and rebuilding; (2) during **COVID-19** His Majesty led the national response and provided **Royal Kidu relief** (income/loan support) to the affected people.

P24 Q2c [4] Grooming of Crown Prince Jigme Khesar for kingship — FOUR evidences: (1) **education abroad** (Andover, Wheaton, Oxford); (2) installed as **Trongsa Poenlop (2004)**; (3) **represented His Majesty at national and public events** (fete days, Japan Day, passing-out ceremony, juvenile centre); (4) **toured the dzongkhags**, meeting villagers and learning their needs, and received gradual responsibility from the Fourth King before 2006.

P24 Q5b [5] His Majesty's youth programmes I find most inspiring: (1) **Gyalsung** — trains every 18-year-old in service and values; (2) **Desuung** — volunteering and discipline; (3) **Kidu for education** (scholarships, help for poor students); (4) **His Majesty's audiences and Golden Youth/leadership events** that motivate young leaders; (5) **youth employment and skills programmes** (e.g. YELP) and the **Gelephu Mindfulness City** creating future jobs.

P24 Q7c [4] Expressing gratitude for the Kidu: (1) **study hard and become a useful citizen**; (2) **serve the community/volunteer** and help others as the Kidu helps me; (3) **be honest, obey laws and protect the environment**; (4) **pray for His Majesty's long life** and **pass on the Kidu spirit** by giving back when I can.

P25 Q4b [5] FIVE events where His Majesty shares moments with the people: (1) **National Day, 17 December**; (2) **Dochula Druk Wangyal Tshechu**; (3) **Royal Highland Festival, Laya**; (4) **Black-Necked Crane Festival, Phobjikha**; (5) the **Thimphu/Punakha tshechus and domchoe** (dancing and addressing the people).

Quick: P24 ii **B** (check); ix **B** (Bhutan Kidney Foundation = Civil Society Organisation); xii **C** (check); b(vi) **leap**. P25 iii **B** (check); vi **B**; ix **C**; c(iii) **e**; c(iv) **b**.

Key dates

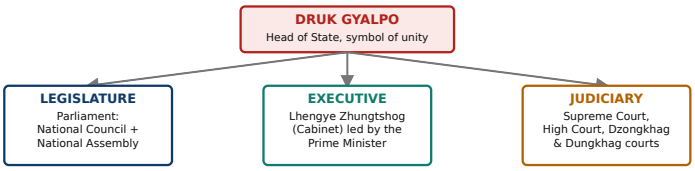
Date	Event
21 Feb 1980	birth
31 Oct 2004	installed as Trongsa Poenlop
9 Dec 2006	becomes Fifth Druk Gyalpo
13 Oct 2011	royal wedding, Punakha Dzong
17 Dec 2019	Gyalsung announced

10 · CONSTITUTION, GNH & ENVIRONMENT

P24 Q1a(viii),d(v,vi),Q7b · P25 Q1a(v,xi),b(b),d(i),Q5a,b

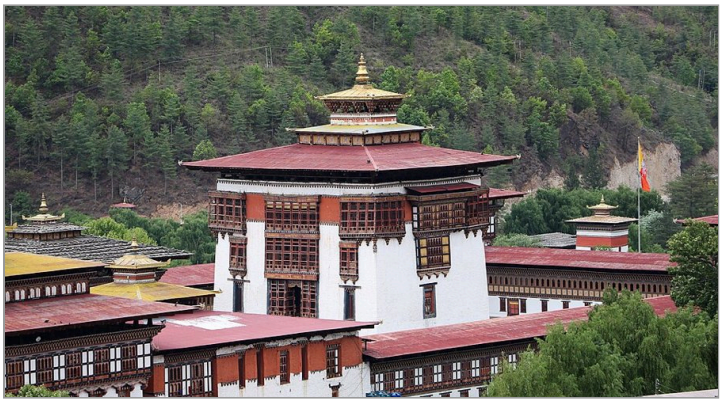
The Constitution of the Kingdom of Bhutan

- **Drafted** from 2001 by a committee led by Chief Justice Sonam Tobgye after nationwide consultation; draft shared in 2005; **enacted 18 July 2008**. It is the **supreme law of modern times**, drafted under the **Royal Command** (compare Kathrim).
- The **Druk Gyalpo** is the **Head of State and symbol of unity** of the Kingdom and the people; he does not preach any religion or represent any party — "the **embodiment of the Constitution**" **P25 Q1a(v): D** **(check)**.
- Three branches: **Legislature** (Parliament: National Council + National Assembly), **Executive** (Lhengye Zhungtshog), **Judiciary**. Commanding that a bill be deliberated in Parliament is a **legislative** matter, not an exercise of executive role → **FALSE** **P24 Q1d(vi)** **(check)**.
- **GNH** is a principle of State policy: four pillars (sustainable and equitable development, environment conservation, culture, good governance). GNH assesses development by **material and spiritual progress together** → **TRUE** **P25 Q1d(i)**.



Separation of powers (Constitution, 2008). Local: Dzongkhag Tshogdu (DT), Gewog Tshogde (GT), Thromde.

Government structure under the Constitution.



Tashichho Dzong, Thimphu — seat of the government and the throne room.
Photo: Bernard Gagnon, CC BY-SA 4.0, Wikimedia Commons.

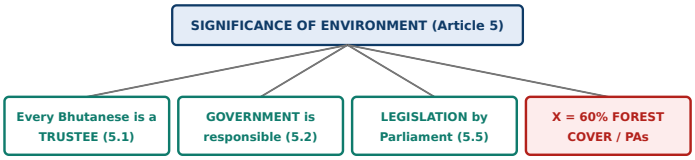


4 pillars | 9 domains: well-being, health, education, time use, culture, governance, community vitality, ecology, living standards

Gross National Happiness: four pillars.

Environment — Article 5

- **Every Bhutanese is a trustee** of the Kingdom's natural resources and environment for present and future generations → **TRUE** **P24 Q1d(v)**; it is the **fundamental duty of every citizen** to protect the environment, conserve biodiversity and prevent ecological degradation (noise, visual and physical pollution), by adopting **eco-friendly practices and policies**.
- The **Government** must protect, conserve and improve the environment, prevent pollution, and keep **at least 60% of the land under forest cover for all time**. **Parliament** enacts environmental legislation.
- Flow chart box **X** **P25 Q1a(xi)**: the paper's chart lists *Trustee, Government responsible, Legislation by Parliament*; X = **declared Protected Areas / forest-cover commitment → A (check)**. Bhutan has about 51% of its land in protected areas and is **carbon negative**.
- To **strengthen the environment** an individual should **educate family and friends** on its importance for sustainability **P24 Q1a(viii): D**.



Box X in the 2025 paper = a government commitment about Protected Areas / forest cover (best option A).

The 2025 flow chart: Significance of Environment.

Solved questions

P24 Q7b [4] What makes Bhutan's Constitution different? (1) It was **drafted on the initiative of the King**, not demanded by revolution, after consulting the people; (2) **GNH is a guiding principle** of State policy; (3) it **requires 60% forest cover for all time** and makes every citizen an environmental **trustee**; (4) **monarchy rules**: the Druk Gyalpo retires at 65 and can be removed by Parliament; also **religious institutions and personalities remain above politics**.

P25 Q5(a) [2] Citizens' responsibilities (Art. 5.1): (1) **protect the natural environment and conserve Bhutan's rich biodiversity** as a trustee for future generations; (2) **prevent all forms of ecological degradation** including noise, visual and physical pollution by following **environment-friendly practices and policies**.

P25 Q5(b) [3] THREE strategies for protecting biodiversity: (1) **keep and expand forest cover (60%)** by plantation and strict forest laws; (2) **strengthen protected areas and biological corridors** and community forestry; (3) **promote clean energy/electric vehicles, waste management and eco-tourism**, with awareness and **environment impact assessment** of projects.

Articles to know

Art.	Subject
1	The Kingdom
2	Institution of Monarchy
3	Spiritual heritage
4	Culture
5	**Environment**
6	Citizenship
7	Fundamental rights
8	Fundamental duties
9	Principles of State policy (GNH)

Roles of the Druk Gyalpo

- Head of State; **symbol of unity** of the Kingdom and people; Supreme Commander of the armed forces; protector of all religions; may grant amnesty (acts above party politics).

11 · CIVIL SOCIETY, COMMUNITY & EVERYDAY LIFE

P24 Q1a(ix),b(iv,v),e(ii) · P25 Q1a(i),Q5c

Key ideas

- **Civil Society Organisations (CSOs)** are non-profit, non-government groups that work for public welfare, e.g. **RENEW** (women), **Bhutan Kidney Foundation**, **Tarayana**, RSPN, Draktsho. The BKF logo represents a **Civil Society Organisation** P24 Q1a(ix): B.
- CSOs are meant to be **non-political** and registered under the **CSO Act (2007)** to keep neutrality and public trust.
- A **victim of domestic abuse** receives support from **RENEW / the National Commission for Women and Children (NCWC)** and the police Women and Child Protection Unit P24 Q1b(v) **(check wording)**.
- **Self-help mechanisms in villages** — neighbours helping with house building, rice planting and harvest by sharing labour — build **community vitality** and cut costs. P25 Q5c 4 photos

Solved questions

P24 Q1e(ii) [2] Should CSOs engage in political activities? **No** — (1) the **CSO Act requires CSOs to be non-political**; (2) political involvement would **destroy neutrality and public trust**, divide society and shift focus from welfare services to party interests.

P25 Q5(c) [1+4] Public awareness campaign on traditional self-help. **Theme: "Together We Build — Self-Help Strengthens Communities." Four messages:** (1) **"Many hands make light work"** — sharing labour (house building, farming) saves money and time; (2) **"Help today, help tomorrow"** — reciprocity builds trust and security in need; (3) **"Keep our culture alive"** — self-help is part of Bhutanese tradition and identity; (4) **"Strong communities, happy lives"** — it supports **GNH** and fights loneliness in town life.

Examples of CSOs

CSO	Focus
RENEW	women, victims of abuse
Bhutan Kidney Foundation	kidney patients
Tarayana	rural poverty alleviation
RSPN	nature conservation

Community vitality is one of the nine GNH domains: trust, volunteering and mutual help (self-help, *woola*).

Culture & identity

- Bhutan's identity rests on **language (Dzongkha), national dress (gho/kira), Driglam Namzha, dzong architecture, festivals (tshechus) and Buddhism**.
- **Preserving culture (youth):** wear the national dress, learn Dzongkha and traditional arts (*Zorig Chusum*), attend festivals, record elders' stories (oral history), respect elders and protect heritage sites.
- The Constitution (Art. 4) asks the State to **preserve, protect and promote** the cultural heritage, including monuments, places and objects of artistic or historic interest, and living traditions.

Likely questions

- **Why should CSOs stay out of politics?** neutrality, trust, focus on welfare.
- **How does self-help help communities?** saves cost, builds trust, keeps traditions, helps in emergencies.
- **How can you contribute to GNH?** volunteer, protect nature, preserve culture, practise good citizenship.

SECTION A ANSWER KEY — 2025 & 2024

every MCQ, blank, match and true/false in one place · (check) = reasoned answer, confirm with your key

2025 Paper — Q1(a) MCQ [15]

No.	Ans	Why (short)
i	**A**	Zhugdrel Phuensum Tshogpa = unity and nationhood of Bhutan
ii	**B**	3rd Five Year Plan chaired by Prince Jigme Singye Wangchuck
iii	**B** (check)	I, III, II, IV order of the Crown Prince's activities
iv	**D**	Sinchula 1865: peace and friendship established
v	**D** (check)	Druk Gyalpo = embodiment of the Constitution / unity
vi	**B**	Dar Kha Nga from Machhen = blessings of the Zhabdrung
vii	**B**	spiritual law of silken knot, secular law of golden yoke
viii	**A**	Ten-Sid = duality of spiritual and secular affairs
ix	**C**	Red Cross: alleviate suffering in emergencies and disasters
x	**B**	British opening a trade agent in Bhutan did not benefit Bhutan
xi	**A** (check)	box X = declared Protected Areas / forest cover
xii	**B** (check)	II Taktsang (tangible) + IV performance (intangible); A also possible
xiii	**A**	Humanising history
xiv	**D**	Great Renunciation
xv	**D**	Globalisation: economic and cultural links

2025 — (b) blanks, (c) match, (d) T/F

Part	Answers
(b) a	the **British**
(b) b	national **priority** / commitment
(b) c	**Driglam Namzha**
(b) d	**society** (values / legal system)
(b) e	**kings / rulers**
(c) i–v	i **c** (Fourth DG) · ii **g** (Zhabdrung) · iii **e** (Druk Gyalpo Jigme Khesar) · iv **b** (Gyalyum Tseyring Pem) **(check)** · v **d** (Columbus)
(d) i–v	i **TRUE** · ii **TRUE** · iii **FALSE** (Kathrim was 17th-century law; the Constitution is the supreme law) · iv **TRUE** · v **TRUE**

2024 Paper — Q1(a) MCQ [15]

No.	Ans	Why (short)
i	**A**	enthroned 2 June 1974
ii	**B** (check)	Highland Festival = economic / livelihood initiative (A social possible)
iii	**C**	Eden success → no war → Duars not annexed
iv	**C**	Chogi Chila Namsum = Trongsa, Daga, Paro Poenlops
v	**B** (check)	Buddha = Awakened One (D also used)
vi	**C** (check)	triangular trade: X slaves (matches only C)
vii	**D**	printing press not explorers' equipment
viii	**D**	educate family and friends about the environment
ix	**B**	Bhutan Kidney Foundation = Civil Society Organisation
x	**D**	2007 treaty: greater autonomy in external affairs
xi	**B**	medieval: influenced by religious beliefs
xii	**C** (check)	Gyalyum Dorji Wangmo: poverty alleviation (Tarayana)
xiii	**B**	baked pottery, drainage, pictographic seals
xiv	**B**	created unique national identity
xv	**C**	India in midst of religious and philosophical reform

2024 — (b) blanks, (c) match, (d) T/F

Part	Answers
(b) i	**Druk Gyalpo**
(b) ii	**reason / evidence**
(b) iii	**town planning** / sanitation
(b) iv	**culture and traditions**
(b) v	**RENEW / NCWC (check wording)**
(b) vi	**leap** year
(b) vii	**Christianity**
(c) i–v	i **b** (check) · ii **d** · iii **f** · iv **a** · v **c**
(d) i–vii	i **TRUE** (check) · ii **TRUE** · iii **FALSE** (1774 was the first treaty) · iv **TRUE** · v **TRUE** · vi **FALSE** (a legislative, not executive, act) (check) · vii **FALSE**

LAST-DAY CHECKLIST

tick when you can write it without looking (most repeated in 2024 / 2025)

- ☐ ☐ Dates: 1616 (Zhabdrung), 1774, 1775, 1864–65 (Sinchula 11 Nov 1865), 1904 (Lhasa treaty 7 Sept), 1907 (17 Dec), 1910, 1949, 2007, 2003 (All Clear), 2006 (abdication), 2008 (Constitution).
- ☐ ☐ Zhabdrung: Choe-sid, Kathrim (Lay-Gyudrey, Tha-Damtsig, 10 virtuous acts), Driglam Namzha, Chogi Chila Namsum = 3 Poenlops.
- ☐ ☐ Treaty table: who signed, what Bhutan gained or lost; 1910 Rs 100,000; 1949 Rs 500,000 + Dewathang; 2007 autonomy.
- ☐ ☐ Ugyen Wangchuck: mediation, KCIE, kingship; Younghusband; Chumbi.
- ☐ ☐ Fourth King: GNH, DYT/GYT, 2003, abdication, Constitution; **selfless leader** five points.
- ☐ ☐ Fifth King: Kidu, Gyalsung, Desuung, Highland Festival; royal patronages.
- ☐ ☐ Constitution: Article 5 trustee, 60% forest, GNH; CSOs non-political.
- ☐ ☐ Indus Valley: grid, baked bricks, drainage, seals; Buddha: Great Renunciation → Middle Path → Enlightenment → Sarnath → Mahaparinirvana; Eightfold Path.
- ☐ ☐ Exploration: 3 Gs, equipment (NOT printing press), Columbian Exchange, triangular trade; Colonialism → nationalism reasons.
- ☐ ☐ Historiography: medieval (religion, kings) vs modern (reason, evidence, all people); oral history ≠ oral tradition; tangible vs intangible.
- ☐ ☐ In answers: count the points asked (TWO / THREE / FIVE) — one fact + one explanation each.